



Find What Is Worth Keeping

Subject: *What did the hard part teach you?*

Dear friend,

Think about this for a moment. A woman leaves a company after many years. For months, she can only talk about what she lost: the title, the routine, the people. Then someone asks her a different question. "What did that job teach you that you will take anywhere?" She is quiet for a while. Then the list starts, and it is longer than she expected.

She is an example - but you may recognize the moment. The day the question changes from "What did I lose?" to "What did I gain?"

That shift is what this month is about.

THE HONEST QUESTION

Every one of these letters starts in the same place. Before you read on, answer this in one sentence: *Where am I today?* Not where you should be. Not where you tell people you are. Where you actually are. Nobody will read it but you.

If the honest answer is hard to find, try three quick tests.

The month test.

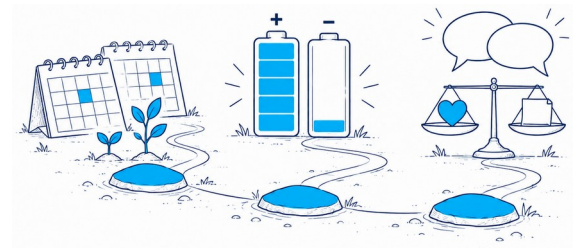
What is different now from a month ago, even slightly?

The energy test.

What gave you energy this week, and what drained it?

The friend test.

Would you say your sentence to a friend in your position? If it sounds harsher than you would ever be with them, keep working on it until it is true and fair.



An honest answer can change from month to month. That is exactly why we keep asking.



THIS MONTH ON THE PATH: REFLECT

Last month was about Accept: letting go of the argument with what has already happened. Once you are standing on that ground, a new question opens up. What can this teach me?

Reflect is the second step on the Path. It means looking back with a purpose. Not to replay every moment, but to find what is worth keeping, what you have learned, and what you are ready to leave behind.

Every setback takes something away. It also shows you, very clearly, what really mattered. The people who stayed close. The strengths you leaned on. The parts of your old life you miss, and the parts you are surprised to be glad are gone.

THE EXERCISE

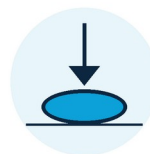
Take a page and make three columns: Keep, Learn and Leave.



KEEP
what I bring with me



LEARN
what this taught me



LEAVE
what I put down

In **Keep**, write what you want to bring into your next chapter. Strengths, people, habits and values.

In **Learn**, write what this setback has taught you. About yourself, about other people and about what you need.

In **Leave**, write what you are ready to put down. An old expectation, a habit or a role that no longer fits.

Then read all three columns together. You are looking at the raw material for what comes next. The Walking Pages, attached, give you the page.

THE TEN-MINUTE STEP

Finish this sentence and write it where you will see it every day: *"Something I know now that I did not know before is..."* That is the whole step.

A CLOSING THOUGHT

Looking back is how you gather what you need for the road ahead. The past has already done its teaching. This month, take the lesson with you.

Until next month,

Maher



Setbacks don't get the last word.

Attached: The Walking Pages